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LINUX FILESYSTEMS AND FILE MANAGEMENT

Storage Management and Configuration

Disk Formatting Utilities

Several tools or utilities can be used to create and/or manipulate device partition tables and partitions. You can see some of these tools in the table below.

Table 5.4: List of Disk Formatting Tools and Their Functionalities

UTILITY	TYPE	COMMENTS
fdisk	text	Menu-driven partition table editor. It is the most standard and one of the most flexible partition table editors. Usually installed. The fdisk command-line utility provides disk-partitioning functions, preparatory to defining filesystems. fdisk is used to create, modify, and delete partitions. You can create a new partition table or modify an existing one. As with any other partition table editor, make sure that you either write down the current partition table settings or make a copy of the current settings before making changes.
sfdisk	text	Non-interactive Linux-based partition editor program, making it useful for scripting. Usually installed. You should use this tool with care!
parted	text	The GNU partition manipulation program. It can create, remove, resize, and move partitions (including certain filesystems). Optional
gnome-disks	graphical	The command to launch the GNOME Disks application, which provides a way to inspect, format, partition and configure disks and block devices.
gparted	graphical	Widely-used graphical interface to parted . Optional package.

NOTE: To partition devices, you should use a partitioning tool that is compatible with the chosen type of partition table. Using incompatible tools may result in the destruction of that table, along with existing partitions or data.